How trading on abdmall works

Buyers and sellers, with abdmall in the middle · October 2026

> abdmall is a place where people buy and sell from each other — **peer to peer, with abdmall as the moderator**. abdmall holds the money, the goods pass through its warehouse, and the buyer sees the item before anyone is paid. Neither side has to trust the other; they only have to trust abdmall.

1 A sale, step by step

1. **A seller lists an item**
   Sellers are met and vetted by abdmall before they can list anything.
2. **A buyer pays into abdmall**
   The money is held by abdmall. The seller has not been paid. The item is reserved so nobody else can buy it.
3. **abdmall tells the seller to bring the goods in**
   This is the point of taking payment first: the seller knows the buyer is serious before making the trip.
4. **The buyer comes to the warehouse and inspects the item**
   In person, with their own eyes, before committing.
5. **If the buyer is happy, they sign for it and take it**
   abdmall then pays the seller, keeping its commission.
6. **If the buyer is not happy, nobody is paid**
   The item goes back to the seller and the buyer is refunded.

> **WHY THIS IS BETTER THAN THE USUAL ARRANGEMENT**
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> The buyer never sends money to a stranger. The seller never hands over goods to one. And because the buyer inspects the item themselves, **abdmall never has to judge whether a product is good enough** — the person who is paying for it decides that.

2 The rules that make it work

Two deadlines and two ways a sale can fall through. Every case has an answer, so nothing sits unresolved:

SITUATION	WHAT HAPPENS
Seller has 48 hours to deliver to the warehouse	If they miss it, the buyer is refunded automatically and the seller gets a strike.
Buyer has 5 days to come and inspect	If they do not come, the item goes back to the seller and the buyer gets a strike.
Buyer rejects because the item is not as described	Full refund. The seller gets a strike — they listed it wrongly.
Buyer rejects because they changed their mind	Full refund, but the buyer gets a strike — the seller made that trip for nothing.

Repeat strikes mean losing access to abdmall. This matters most to sellers: they are the ones who spend time and transport on every sale, and they will stop using abdmall if buyers waste their trips without consequence.

SOMETHING TO WATCH

We suggest **not deducting any money** from a buyer's refund at first, even when the wasted trip is their fault — taking money off a refund causes more arguments than it is worth. Strikes alone should be enough while volumes are small. If wasted trips become common, a small fee paid to the seller can be added later. It is much easier to introduce one than to remove one.

3 The numbers

ITEM	VALUE
abdmall's commission	**10% of the sale price**, taken from the seller when the sale completes
Seller delivery window	48 hours from the buyer paying
Buyer collection window	5 days from the goods arriving
Collection points	One warehouse to begin with

The seller only pays when they are paid, which makes abdmall easy to join. Nothing is charged for a sale that falls through.

4 How the money moves

	WHAT HAPPENS
Step 1	A buyer decides to buy. Our payment provider creates a **one-off account number for that sale only**.
Step 2	The buyer transfers to it. Because that number belongs to one sale, the payment arrives **already matched** — nothing for the buyer to quote or mistype.
Step 3	The money lands in **one pot held by the payment provider**, tagged with the sale. The account number is only a label — it holds nothing itself.
Step 4	It sits there untouched while the seller delivers and the buyer inspects.
Step 5a	**Buyer accepts** — 90% is transferred to the seller, and abdmall's 10% moves to its business account.
Step 5b	**Sale falls through** — the full amount is transferred back to the buyer.

Three rules go with it:

- **Take transfers, not cards.** A card payment can be reversed by the buyer's bank months later — by then the buyer has the goods and the seller has been paid. Transfers cannot be undone that way. Cards are fine for low-value items.
- **The held balance is not abdmall's money.** It is the buyer's until they accept, then the seller's, and is never drawn on for rent, salaries or the warehouse. No separate account is needed at first — but open a business account that only ever receives the 10% commission.
- **Check seller bank details at vetting**, not when there is money to send.

ONE NUMBER TO WATCH, DAILY

The money being held should always come to **exactly the total of sales paid for but not yet completed**. If the two ever differ, something has gone wrong and it should be looked at that day rather than at month end.

5 What this means for abdmall

- **A room and someone to run it.** Goods only arrive after a buyer has paid, and leave within days, so this is a holding room rather than a warehouse full of stock.
- **Meeting every seller.** This is the strongest protection in the whole design. Because you have met them, a strike means something and a seller taking money and disappearing is far less likely.
- **The money being held is not abdmall's.** It belongs to the buyer until they accept the goods, and to the seller after that. It is never drawn on to run the business.
- **One judgement to make.** When a buyer rejects an item, someone decides whether it was genuinely not as described, or the buyer simply changed their mind. That is the only call abdmall has to make, and it is made with the item and the listing photographs both in front of you.

> **WORTH SETTLING EARLY**
>
> **One warehouse means one city.** The website must make the collection location clear before anyone pays, or you will spend your time refunding buyers who did not realise they had to travel.

6 Legal and paperwork

WHAT	WHY
A conversation with your bank and a lawyer	Holding money on behalf of other people is **regulated in Nigeria**. Many platforms operate this way — it is about doing it knowingly rather than discovering it at volume.
A written agreement sellers accept when they join	The 10% commission, the 48-hour deadline, what a strike means, and that abdmall decides whether a rejection was fair.
Terms buyers accept when they buy	The 5-day collection window, what happens if they do not come, and that inspecting the item is their responsibility.
A signed receipt at collection	The buyer signs for the item as they take it. This is the record that protects abdmall if a sale is ever disputed afterwards.
A word with your accountant	Nigeria has withholding tax obligations when a business pays vendors. The 10% commission is also business income and should be recorded separately from money held in escrow.
Accounts in the company's registered name	The payment provider account, and any bank account money settles into, should be in abdmall's name, matching the CAC documents exactly.

7 What we need from you

- The **warehouse address**, and the hours buyers can come to inspect.
- How you want to **vet sellers** — what you check, and who does it.
- Confirmation of the four numbers in section 3.
- A **business bank account** for abdmall's commission, if one is not already in place.

Once we have those, we can build it.